been severely burnt. She had narrated the events to them when Ragothaman showed her the first photograph. She had immediately recalled the kurta-pyjama-clad man and the woman in the green-and-orange salwar kameez in the red carpet area, and added that there was a young photographer who had been taking their photographs just before the arrival of Rajiv Gandhi.

Soon after *The Hindu* had published the first photograph taken by Haribabu, another photojournalist, Bhagwan Singh, had got in touch with the SIT and expressed doubts about the man in the kurta pyjama. Singh knew Haribabu and had seen him in Sriperumbudur that night; he said the latter had introduced the kurta-pyjama-clad man as the 'partner' of another photographer, Ravi Shankar. Next day, when Singh called Shankar and inquired about his so-called 'partner', Shankar admitted to having lent his Chinon camera to Haribabu but declined any knowledge of the man in the kurta pyjama.

Shankar's denial had bothered Singh, especially after hearing about the possible involvement of the LTTE in the assassination. Singh knew Haribabu was well known to senior photojournalist Subha Sundaram, whose close links with the LTTE were no secret. He also knew that Sundaram had contacted Haribabu's father, Sundermani, and advised him to dispose of his photographer son's cache of letters and pro-LTTE propaganda material. Although news of his sympathies for the LTTE had appeared in the local press, Haribabu's home was yet to be raided. Luckily for the SIT, Haribabu's family had not acted upon Sundaram's repeated advice of destroying all LTTE-related material their deceased son had stored at home. Nor had they approached the police to inform them about their son's LTTE connections.

Verma and Ragothaman's interaction with Anusuya and Shankar had helped the SIT establish a connection between the suspected dead assassin, the dead photographer Haribabu and the man holding a pen and notebook in the same photograph, clad in a white kurta pyjama. Anusuya had asked the suspected assassin if she had permission to enter the VVIP area. Before she could give a satisfying answer, the photographer (Haribabu) had come in. His reply to Anusuya was that the girl was supposed to garland Rajiv